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Coil electronic component

Abstract

A coil electronic component includes a support substrate having a thickness of 20 to 40 μm . A coil pattern is disposed on at least one of a first surface and a second surface of the support substrate opposing each other, and has an aspect ratio of 4 or higher. An encapsulant encapsulates at least portions of the support substrate and the coil pattern, and an external electrode is disposed in an external region of the encapsulant and connected to the coil pattern.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

(1) This application claims benefit of priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2018-0126609 filed on Oct. 23, 2018 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(2) The present disclosure relates to a coil electronic component.

2. Description of Related Art

(3) As electronic devices such as digital televisions, mobile phones, laptops, and the like, have been designed to have reduced sizes, demand has increased for coil electronic components configured for use in such electronic devices and having a reduced size. To meet such demand, a large number of studies into developing various types of coil-type or thin-film type coil electronic components have been conducted.

(4) One important difficulty in developing a coil electronic component having a reduced size is to provide a coil component having the same properties as before after reducing a size thereof. To this end, a content of a magnetic material filling a core may be increased. However, there may be a limitation in increasing a content of the magnetic material due to strength of an inductor body, changes in frequency property caused by insulating property, and for other reasons.

(5) There have been continuous attempts to further reduce a thickness of a chip including a coil electronic component. In particular, in the respective technical field, efforts have been made to provide devices providing high performance and reliability while having a reduced size.

SUMMARY

(6) An aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a coil electronic component having improved direct current resistance property and Ls property.

(7) According to an aspect of the present disclosure, a coil electronic component is provided, the coil electronic component including a support substrate having a thickness of 20 to 40 μm . A coil pattern is disposed on at least one of a first surface and a second surface of the support substrate

opposing each other, and has an aspect ratio of 4 or higher. An encapsulant encapsulates at least portions of the support substrate and the coil pattern, and an external electrode is disposed in an external region of the encapsulant and connected to the coil pattern.

(8) When a region of the encapsulant covering the coil pattern is defined as a cover portion, a thickness of the cover portion may be less than a thickness of the coil pattern.

(9) The thickness of the coil pattern may be two or more times the thickness of the cover portion.

(10) The aspect ratio of the coil pattern may be 10 or higher.

(11) A thickness of the coil pattern may be three or more times the thickness of the support substrate.

(12) The coil pattern may be disposed on both of the first surface and the second surface of the support substrate.

(13) The encapsulant may include magnetic grains and an insulating resin.

(14) The encapsulant may fill a region between adjacent winding patterns of the coil pattern.

(15) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a coil electronic component includes a support substrate having first and second surfaces opposite each other in a thickness direction. A coil having a first coil pattern is disposed on the first surface, and has a thickness measured in the thickness direction that is three or more times a thickness of the support substrate measured in the thickness direction. An encapsulant encapsulates at least portions of the support substrate and the coil pattern.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The above and other aspects, features, and advantages of the present disclosure will be more clearly understood from the following detailed description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective diagram illustrating a coil electronic component according to an example embodiment of the present disclosure; and

(3) FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional diagram taken along line I-I' in FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(4) Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be described as follows with reference to the attached drawings.

(5) The present disclosure may, however, be exemplified in many different forms and should not be construed as being limited to the specific embodiments set forth herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the disclosure to those skilled in the art. Accordingly, shapes and sizes of the elements in the drawings can be exaggerated for clear description. Also, elements having the same function within the scope of the same concept represented in the drawing of each exemplary embodiment will be described using the same reference numerals.

(6) FIG. 1 is a perspective diagram illustrating a coil electronic component according to an example embodiment. FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional diagram taken along line I-I' in FIG. 1.

(7) Referring to the diagrams, a coil electronic component **100** in the example embodiment may include an encapsulant **101**, a support substrate **102**, a coil pattern **103**, and external electrodes **105** and **106**. The support substrate **102** may be configured to have a reduced thickness and the coil pattern **103** may be configured to have a relatively high aspect ratio such that electronic and magnetic properties may improve.

(8) The encapsulant **101** may encapsulate at least portions of the support substrate **102** and the coil pattern **103**, and may form an exterior of the coil electronic component **100**. In example embodiments, a length (a length taken in an X direction in FIG. 1) of the encapsulant **101** may be

greater than a thickness (a length taken in a Z direction in FIG. 1), and a ratio of a thickness to a length of the encapsulant **101** may be 0.6 or lower approximately. The coil electronic component **100** having a reduced thickness as described above may be a low profile component. In the case of the coil electronic component **100** having a low profile form, there may be a limitation in increasing a size of the coil pattern **103** such that it may be difficult to improve electronic and magnetic properties. In the example embodiment, aspect ratios of the support substrate **102** and the coil pattern **103** may be limited to a certain range to improve such property.

(9) The encapsulant **101** may be configured to partially expose a lead-out pattern L. The encapsulant **101** may include magnetic grains, and an insulating resin may be interposed between the magnetic grains. Surfaces of the magnetic grains may be coated with an insulating film. As the magnetic grains included in the encapsulant **101**, ferrite, a metal, and the like, may be used. When the magnetic grains are configured as a metal, the magnetic grains may be an Fe-based alloy, and the like. For example, the magnetic grains may be a nanocrystalline grain boundary alloy having a composition of Fe—Si—B—Cr, an Fe—Ni based alloy, and the like. As an example, a grain size of an Fe-based alloy grain may be 0.1 μm or greater to 20 μm or less, and the Fe-based alloy grains may be distributed on a macromolecule phase such as an epoxy resin or polyimide. When the magnetic grains are implemented by an Fe-based alloy as described above, however, although magnetic property such as permeability, and the like, may be improved, the magnetic grains may be vulnerable to electrostatic discharge. Accordingly, an additional insulation structure may be interposed between the coil pattern **103** and the magnetic grains. Also, the encapsulant **101** may fill a region between adjacent patterns in the coil pattern **103** as illustrated in the diagram.

(10) The support substrate **102** may support the coil pattern **103**, and may be implemented as a polypropylene glycol (PPG) substrate, a ferrite substrate or a metal-based soft magnetic substrate, and the like. As illustrated in the diagram, a through hole C may be formed in a central portion of the support substrate **102**, penetrating through the support substrate **102**, and the through hole C may be filled with the encapsulant **101**, thereby forming a magnetic core portion. In the example embodiment, a thickness T.sub.1 of the support substrate **102** may be configured to be 20 to 30 μm , which is less than a thickness of a support substrate used in a general coil electronic component. By configuring the thickness T.sub.1 of the support substrate **102** to be less than a thickness of a support substrate used in a general coil electronic component, a thickness T.sub.2 of the coil pattern **103** may increase and an amount of the encapsulant **101** filling the region between the patterns of the coil pattern **103** may also increase. Thus, as the thickness T.sub.2 of the coil pattern **103** increases, direct current resistance R_{dc} property may improve with reference to a component having the same thickness, and as the amount of magnetic grains included in the encapsulant **101** increases, L_s property may also improve.

(11) The coil pattern **103** may be disposed on at least one of a first surface (an upper surface in FIG. 2) and a second surface (a lower surface in FIG. 2) of the support substrate **102** opposing each other. In the example embodiment, the coil pattern **103** may include a first coil pattern **103a** disposed on the first surface of the support substrate **102** and a second coil pattern **103b** disposed on the second surface, but an example embodiment thereof is not limited thereto. The coil pattern **103** may be disposed on only one surface. The first and second coil patterns **103a** and **103b** may include a pad region P, and may be connected to each other through a via V penetrating through the support substrate **102**. The coil pattern **103** may be formed by a plating process generally used in the respective technical field, such as a pattern plating process, an anisotropic plating process, an isotropic plating process, or the like, and the coil pattern **103** may be configured to have a multilayer structure using a plurality of processes from among the aforementioned processes.

(12) The external electrodes **105** and **106** may be disposed externally of the encapsulant **101** and may each be connected to a respective lead-out pattern L. The external electrodes **105** and **106** may be formed using a paste including a metal having a high electrical conductivity, and the paste may be a conductive paste including one of nickel (Ni), copper (Cu), tin (Sn) or silver (Ag), or alloys

thereof, for example. Each of the external electrodes **105** and **106** may further include a plating layer formed thereon. In this case, the plating layer may include one or more elements selected from a group consisting of nickel (Ni), copper (Cu), and tin (Sn). For example, a nickel (Ni) plated layer and a tin (Sn) plated layer may be formed in order.

(13) The lead-out pattern L may be disposed in an outermost region of the coil pattern **103**, may provide a connection path with the external electrodes **105** and **106**, and may be configured to be integrated with the coil pattern **103**. In this case, as illustrated in the diagram, the lead-out pattern L may be configured to have a width greater than a width W of the coil pattern **103** to be connected to the external electrodes **105** and **106**. The width may be a width taken in the X direction in FIG. 1.

(14) In the example embodiment, an aspect ratio of the coil pattern **103**, a ratio of the thickness $T_{sub.2}$ to the width W, may be 4 or higher. As described above, when the support substrate **102** is configured to have a reduced thickness, an aspect ratio of the coil pattern **103** may effectively increase. When an aspect ratio of the coil pattern **103** increases, a size of a cross-sectional surface of the coil pattern **103** may also increase such that direct current resistance property of the coil electronic component **100** may decrease. The more the cross-sectional surface of the coil pattern **103** increases, the more the direct current resistance of the coil pattern **103** may decrease.

(15) In this case, an aspect ratio of the coil pattern **103** may increase in accordance with required properties, and may be 10 or higher, for example. As a thickness of the support substrate **102** decreases and a thickness of the coil pattern **103** increases, an amount of the encapsulant **101** filling a region between the adjacent winding patterns of the coil pattern **103** may also increase such that an amount of the magnetic grains included in the encapsulant **101** may also increase. The increase of the amount of the magnetic grains included in the encapsulant **101** may affect improvement of magnetic property of the coil electronic component **100**, and may improve/increase Ls property. The thickness $T_{sub.2}$ of the coil pattern **103** may be three or more times the thickness $T_{sub.1}$ of the support substrate **102**. In this case, direct current resistance property may decrease and Ls property may improve/increase without increasing a thickness of the coil electronic component **100**.

(16) When a region of the encapsulant **101** covering the coil pattern **103** may be defined as a cover portion, a thickness $T_{sub.3}$ of the cover portion may be less than the thickness $T_{sub.2}$ of the coil pattern **103**. The thickness $T_{sub.3}$ may refer to a thickness of an upper cover portion covering the first coil pattern **103a** or a lower cover portion covering the second coil pattern **103b**. The thickness $T_{sub.2}$ of the coil pattern **103** may be two or more times the thickness $T_{sub.3}$ of the cover portion. By configuring a thickness of the coil pattern **103** to be greater than the thicknesses of the support substrate **102** and of the cover portion as described above, direct current resistance property may decrease and Ls property of the coil electronic component **100** may improve.

(17) The inventors manufactured coil electronic components under the conditions as below, and compared the direct current resistance property and Ls property of the coil electronic component of an embodiment and of the coil electronic component of a comparative example with each other. In the two manufactured components, a length of a coil pattern was configured to be the same, 2000 μm . Also, overall thicknesses of the components were the same.

(1) Comparative Example

(18) a width of a coil pattern: 10 μm a thickness of a coil pattern: 100 μm a thickness of a support substrate: 60 μm

(2) Embodiment

(19) a width of a coil pattern: 10 μm a thickness of a coil pattern: 115 μm a thickness of a support substrate: 30 μm

(20) As a result of the comparison between the components implemented as above, when direct current resistance property of the comparative example is 100%, direct current resistance property of the embodiment improved to 87%. As for an Ls property, when the Ls property of the comparative example is 100%, the Ls property of the embodiment increased to 115%. Thus, by

using the coil pattern having a relatively high aspect ratio and the support substrate having a reduced thickness suggested in the example embodiment, direct current resistance may be reduced and inductance may increase as compared to a general component having the same thickness.

(21) According to the aforementioned example embodiments, even when a thickness of the coil electronic component is reduced, direct current resistance property may decrease and Ls property of the component may improve/increase.

(22) While the exemplary embodiments have been shown and described above, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that modifications and variations could be made without departing from the scope of the present invention as defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A coil electronic component, comprising: a support member having a thickness of 20 to 40 μm ; a coil pattern disposed on at least one of a first surface and a second surface of the support member opposing each other, and having an aspect ratio of 11.5 or higher; an encapsulant encapsulating at least portions of the support member and the coil pattern; and an external electrode disposed in an external region of the encapsulant and connected to the coil pattern, wherein a thickness of the coil pattern is two or more times a distance from an upper surface of the encapsulant to the coil pattern, and wherein a ratio of a thickness to a length of the encapsulant is 0.6 or lower.
2. The coil electronic component of claim 1, wherein the thickness of the coil pattern is three or more times the thickness of the support member.
3. The coil electronic component of claim 1, wherein the coil pattern is disposed on both of the first surface and the second surface of the support member.
4. The coil electronic component of claim 1, wherein the encapsulant includes magnetic grains and an insulating resin.
5. The coil electronic component of claim 4, wherein the encapsulant fills a region between adjacent winding patterns of the coil pattern.
6. The coil electronic component of claim 1, wherein the first and second surfaces oppose each other in a thickness direction; the coil pattern has a first coil pattern disposed on the first surface, and has a thickness in the thickness direction that is three or more times the thickness of the support member in the thickness direction.
7. The coil electronic component of claim 6, wherein the coil pattern further includes: a second coil pattern disposed on the second surface, and having a thickness in the thickness direction that is three or more times the thickness of the support member in the thickness direction; and a conductive via extending through the thickness of the support member to connect the first and second coil patterns to each other.
8. The coil electronic component of claim 6, wherein the encapsulant includes magnetic grains, the first coil pattern includes a plurality of windings, and the magnetic grains of the encapsulant extend into a space between adjacent windings of the plurality of windings.
9. The coil electronic component of claim 8, wherein the magnetic grains of the encapsulant extend into the space between the adjacent windings of the plurality of windings to a depth, measured in a thickness direction from a surface of the first coil pattern opposite to the first surface, that is three or more times the thickness of the support member.
10. The coil electronic component of claim 6, wherein the first coil pattern extends in the thickness direction between a base surface contacting the first surface of the support member and a peripheral surface opposite the base surface, and the encapsulant forms a cover portion extending over the peripheral surface of the first coil pattern and having a thickness that is half or less of the thickness of the first coil pattern.

11. The coil electronic component of claim 1, wherein the thickness of the support member is 20 to 30 μm .
